

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 4
 ♥ K 10 9 7 4 3
 ♦ A Q 7
 ♣ A 10

♠ A Q J 8 2

♥ A Q J 5

♦ J 6

♣ 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 3

♥ 8 2

♦ 10 9 5 4 2

♣ K 8 6 3

♠ K 10 7 5

♥ 6

♦ K 8 3

♣ Q J 9 5 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Lead: ♥ 8

The extra winner would permit North to discard 2 of dummy's ♦ losers, and this would give North the contract.

[showcards W:H8 N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. South's 2♥ bid shows good ♠ support with at least 10 points.

Partner led the ♥ 8, dummy played the ♥ 6

Play a small ♥.

Partner's ♥ 8 lead is a high spot card, either top-of-nothing, or a singleton or doubleton. He definitely does not have an honor, which means that North holds ♥ A Q J.

In other words, your ♥ K is dead in the water. BUT, if you play it to this trick you hand North three ♥ tricks, while if you play a low ♥ he can only get 2 winners in the suit.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 6 4
 ♥ Q J 10 5 3
 ♦ 8 5
 ♣ A 10 4

♠ K 7 3
 ♥ 9 6 4
 ♦ K J 6
 ♣ K J 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 8 5
 ♥ K 7
 ♦ 9 7 4 3
 ♣ 8 7 2

♠ A 10 2
 ♥ A 8 2
 ♦ A Q 10 2
 ♣ Q 6 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥Q

the ♥K. AND HE WILL STILL HAVE HIS ♥A when you switch to another suit. He will have time to drive out the ♣A while he still has ♥s stopped.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥K.

Admittedly you have a terrible hand. But that's no reason to be careless. **YOU** can beat this contract, but you have to do it right now by unblocking the ♥K. If declarer holds up you will continue with your ♥7 and partner will establish his suit while he still has the ♣A for an entry. If declarer doesn't hold up it will be just as bad for him.

But suppose you say "Well, partner's ♥Q is just as good as my ♥K so I'll just save the King for later" as you play low. Declarer will love you. He will hold up on the ♥Q, then again on trick two when you play

It was a good thing you held the ♥K rather than declarer, but it is a nuisance that you must get out of the way on the very first trick.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 6 2
 ♥ K Q 3
 ♦ 10 9 8 5
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ 5 4

♥ 10 8 7 4

♦ Q J 6

♣ K 6 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 3

♥ J 9 6 2

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 10 8

♠ A Q J 10 7

♥ A 5

♦ K 4 2

♣ A J 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	1NT	Pass	1 ♠
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All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥ 2

If declarer played low on the first trick you would win the ♥ Q, then play the ♥ K to dummy's ♥ A.

[showcards W:H2 N:HA]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥ 2, dummy played the ♥ A

Play the ♥ Q (or ♥ K).

You know partner has a 4-card ♥ suit, (he led the deuce), and you know it is headed by an honor. You hope the honor is the ♥ J, but in any case you must get your high ♥ s out of the way.

Declarer will probably come to his hand and then take a ♠ finesse. You win the ♠ K, take your other high ♥, then lead your ♥ 3 toward your partner.

As you see, partner did hold the ♥ J 9, so your side wins 3 ♥ tricks.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 6 5

♥ A K 3

♦ Q 7 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ K 9 2

♥ Q 10 9 8 5

♦ A 6

♣ A 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 7

♥ 6 4 2

♦ 10 9 8 5

♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 4 3

♥ J 7

♦ K J 4 3

♣ K Q J 5

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ 5

wins a high ♥ he will play another ♠ through dummy's ♠ K 9 to your ♠ A J. Once you clear dummy's ♠ away partner will win another ♥ and be able to cash his last ♠.

[showcards W:S5 N:S2]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 5, dummy played the ♠ 2

Play the ♠ 7.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you he has an honor in the suit, so it must be either the ♠ Q or the ♠ 10. South's jump to 2NT makes it almost certain that he holds the ♠ Q, so you can figure partner probably led from ♠ 10 x x 5.

Apply the Rule of 11. 11 minus 5 = 6 cards higher than the ♠ 5 held by dummy, you, and declarer.

Since you can see 5 of the 6 you conclude that that declarer will have to play his ♠ Q to beat your ♠ 7.

South will take the ♠ Q at trick 1, but when West

Note that if dummy's ♠ 9 was played you would cover with your ♠ J, leading to the same situation.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 3
♥ A Q 7
♦ J 10 8 7 3
♣ K 6

♠ A Q 10

♥ K 4 3

♦ K Q 9 2

♣ Q 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 5 2

♥ J 10 6 5 2

♦ 6 4

♣ 9 3

♠ J 6 4

♥ 9 8

♦ A 5

♣ A J 10 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥5

whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to East.

So assume North actually holds the ♥K x x. If you play the ♥A to trick one, then lead ♥Q, North will hold up on the second trick, and win the third ♥. Then, when you win your ♣K you will not have a ♥ to return to partner and declarer will make the contract.

So what happens if you play the ♥Q at trick one? North could still make the contract by holding up, **but he will be afraid to do so**. After all, from his perspective it looks like East probably holds the ♥A and he will be afraid of losing the first 5 ♥ tricks, perhaps even when the ♣K finessing is working!

[showcards W:H5 N:H8]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥5, dummy played the ♥8

Play the ♥Q.

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 6 cards in South, West and North that are higher than the ♥5. You can see 5 of them, so that leaves just one of them for North.

East cannot have all three of the outstanding honors, because from ♥K J 10 x x his correct lead would be the Jack. So you can deduce that North must hold exactly one of ♥K, ♥J, or ♥10.

If his honor is not the ♥K then it won't matter whether you play ♥A or ♥Q to the first trick; you will win your two top cards and then play your small one back to East.